

Kingly sum: Harshal Patel was the Indian with the highest bid at this auction, as the Punjab Kings snapped him up for Rs 11.75 crore. GETTY IMAGES



MONEY TALKS

The teams that entered the IPL 2024 auction with the largest purses **left the arena** with the least baggage.

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Fair warning.' Even if one were to guess the top two buys at the IPL 2024 auction, the likelihood of accurately predicting the winning bids would have been quite slim.

With 77 openings available and 332 players in the mix, franchises swiftly pursued their desired picks in the initial five rounds.

Here's a breakdown: Of the Rs 230.45 crore spent on 72 players — the most for a mini-auction and the

fourth-most since 2013 — a staggering 65.13 per cent (Rs 150.10 crore) was splurged on 25 players from the first 36 available in the pool.

The intense and assertive bidding concluded with record-breaking numbers and astonishing sales at the Coca-Cola Arena in Dubai. The auction strategies and choices boiled down to a significant gap in experience and skills between the